

Form Submission Setup

What Problem Are We Solving?

The PWI website has three forms visitors can fill out:

- **General Inquiry** — for sales, technical support, certifications, or general questions
- **Quote Request** — for pricing and product availability
- **Newsletter Signup** — to join the PWI mailing list

Why Google Apps Script?

Google Apps Script is a free tool built into Google that lets you write small programs connected to Google services. In this case it acts as the middleman — it receives the form data, composes an email, and sends it using Google's own mail infrastructure.

The key advantage over a server-side solution is deliverability. Google's mail servers are trusted by virtually every email provider, so emails sent this way are far less likely to land in spam than those sent from a shared hosting server. It is also completely free and requires no changes to the GoDaddy hosting account.

The Big Picture — What Happens When Someone Hits Submit

Here is the full journey of a form submission, step by step:

1. Visitor fills out the form

The visitor types their name, email, message, etc. and clicks the Submit button.

2. JavaScript intercepts the submission

Instead of the form doing a traditional page reload, a small JavaScript snippet on the page intercepts the Submit click, collects all the form fields, and sends them directly to Google Apps Script in the background. The visitor stays on the same page.

3. Google Apps Script checks for spam

Each form has a hidden honeypot field. Real visitors never see it or fill it in. Spam bots automatically fill in every field they find — including hidden ones. If the honeypot field has any content, Google Apps Script discards the submission silently and returns a success response so the bot has no idea it was blocked.

4. Google Apps Script sends the email

Google Apps Script composes a plain-text email with all the form fields clearly labeled and sends it to sales@pwi-e.com using Google's own mail servers. The Reply-To address is set to the visitor's email, so hitting Reply in any email client goes straight back to the visitor — not to a no-reply address.

5. Google Apps Script confirms success

After sending the email, the script sends a success or error signal back to the page.

6. A confirmation message appears

The JavaScript on the form page receives the signal and shows a green banner on success, or a red banner with a fallback email address if something went wrong. The form disappears and the visitor sees the confirmation immediately without any page reload.

Files Created

Four files were added to the website. Here is what each one does:

google-apps-script/Code.gs

The Google Apps Script code. This file is not uploaded to GoDaddy — it lives in Google. It handles all three forms in one place, identified by a `form_type` field sent with each submission. One script covers General Inquiry, Quote Request, and Newsletter Signup.

contact-form.html (updated)

A JavaScript block was added that intercepts the form submit, sends the data to Google Apps Script in the background, and shows a success or error banner without reloading the page.

request-quote.html (updated)

Same update as `contact-form.html` — fetch-based submission replacing the old server POST.

newsletter-signup.html (updated)

Same update. Also handles the interest checkboxes correctly when sending to Google Apps Script.

What the Email Looks Like When It Arrives

Emails arrive at `sales@pwi-e.com` as plain text. Here is an example from the General Inquiry form:

```
From: PWI Web Form <noreply@pwi-e.com>
Reply-To: Jane Smith <jane@exampleaviation.com>
Subject: [PWI Contact] Sales Inquiry
```

```
Name: Jane Smith
Email: jane@exampleaviation.com
Phone: +1 316 555 1234
Company: Example Aviation LLC
Inquiry Type: Sales Inquiry
Product: 303 LED lamp, part no. 7310056
Heard About: Google search
```

Message:

We need pricing on 12 units for our King Air B200 fleet. Can you also confirm availability and lead time?

Important: The From address shows 'PWI Web Form' so the email is clearly identified as coming from the website. However, the Reply-To is set to the visitor's email address. This means if anyone at PWI hits Reply, their response goes directly to the visitor — not to a no-reply address.

What the Visitor Sees After Submitting

After submitting a form, the visitor is immediately sent back to the same form page. One of two messages appears at the top of the page:

If the email was sent successfully:

A green banner appears that says: "Your message was sent successfully. We'll be in touch shortly."

If something went wrong (rare):

A red banner appears that says: "Something went wrong. Please try again or email sales@pwi-e.com directly."

This gives the visitor an alternative way to reach PWI even if the form fails.

The form itself stays on the page — the visitor can resubmit if needed. The page design is completely unchanged.

The banners use the same styling already present on the site.

Spam Protection

A honeypot is a trap for spam bots. Here is how it works:

Each form contains a hidden field named 'website'. It is invisible to real visitors — hidden using CSS so it never appears on the page. A real person filling out the form will never see it and will never fill it in.

Spam bots work differently. They scan a page for form fields and automatically fill in every field they find, including hidden ones. When Google Apps Script receives a submission where the website field has any content, it knows it came from a bot — not a real person. It silently discards it and returns a success response. No email is sent. No error is shown. The bot has no idea it was blocked.

This won't catch every spam bot, but it stops the vast majority of automated submissions without requiring visitors to solve a CAPTCHA puzzle.

Google Account Setup — One-Time Step

The Google Apps Script needs to be created and deployed once before the forms will work on the live site. This is a manual step that takes about five minutes.

Which Google account should this be set up under?

The script should be created under a PWI company Google account — not a personal Gmail. This ensures that if a team member leaves, PWI still owns and controls the script. If PWI does not already have a Google Workspace account, a free Gmail account created specifically for PWI (e.g. pwi.webforms@gmail.com) works fine as a fallback.

What is the 'This app isn't verified' warning?

During setup, Google will show a warning screen that says 'This app isn't verified.' This looks alarming but is completely normal. It appears for any script you write yourself in Google Apps Script — Google requires a formal review process only for apps published to the public. Since this script is private and written by us, it does not go through that process. To proceed past the warning: click 'Advanced' at the bottom left of the warning screen, then click 'Go to [project name] (unsafe)'. This is safe to do.

The only permission the script requests is the ability to send email. It cannot read existing emails, access files, or do anything else.

Setup Steps

1. Go to script.google.com and sign in with the PWI Google account.
2. Click New Project in the top left.
3. Delete any existing code in the editor.

4. Open the file `google-apps-script/Code.gs` from the website project folder and paste its entire contents into the editor.
5. Click the floppy disk icon or press `Ctrl+S` (`Cmd+S` on Mac) to save.
6. Click Deploy in the top right, then New Deployment.
7. Click the gear icon next to Type and select Web App.
8. Set Execute as to Me.
9. Set Who has access to Anyone.
10. Click Deploy.
11. If prompted with 'This app isn't verified' — click Advanced at the bottom of the screen, then click the project name link to continue. This screen appears for any privately-written script and is expected.
12. Click through the permissions to allow the script to send email.
13. Copy the Web App URL that appears after deployment. It will look similar to:
`script.google.com/macros/s/ABC.../exec`
14. Send that URL to the developer to paste into the three form pages. The developer will handle this step — no code editing needed on your end.

The script only needs to be deployed once. If the `Code.gs` file is ever updated in the future, click Deploy → Manage Deployments → Edit to create a new version. The URL will change, so the developer will need to update it in the three form pages.

How to Test After Going Live

Once the site is on GoDaddy, run through these steps to confirm everything is working:

1. Go to the Contact Form page on the live site and fill it out with real test data. Hit Submit.
2. Confirm the green success banner appears and the form disappears — no page reload.
3. Check `sales@pwi-e.com` and confirm the email arrived with all the correct fields labeled.
4. Hit Reply on the email and confirm it addresses the test sender — not a no-reply address.
5. Repeat for the Quote Request form and the Newsletter Signup form.
6. If emails are not arriving, check the Google Apps Script deployment is set to Anyone can access, and that the script has been authorized (step 9 above).
7. If the script needs to be re-authorized, open `script.google.com`, open the project, and run the `doPost` function manually — Google will prompt for permissions again.

Frequently Asked Questions

Does customer data get stored by Google?

No. Google Apps Script acts as a pass-through only. When a form is submitted, the script receives the data, immediately sends it as an email to sales@pwi-e.com, and does not write it to any Google database, Sheet, or Drive file. The data is in Google's infrastructure for a fraction of a second during processing. If a permanent submission log is ever required, that would need to be explicitly added to the script.

Who is responsible for maintaining the script after setup?

The script lives in the Google account it was created under. Whoever manages that account is responsible for it going forward. The main maintenance task is re-authorization if Google's permissions expire — a one-minute process described in the testing section. Any changes to email content, recipient address, or form fields would require a developer to update the Code.gs file and redeploy.

Does this affect the website design or any other pages?

No. The only changes are a JavaScript block added to the bottom of the three form pages. The forms look and behave exactly the same from the visitor's perspective. No other pages were touched.

Is this free?

Yes. Google Apps Script is completely free. There are daily email sending limits (100 emails/day for a standard Google account, 1,500/day for Google Workspace), but a contact form on a business site is extremely unlikely to approach those limits.

What if we want to change the email address submissions go to?

Open the Code.gs file in Google Apps Script, find the line that says sales@pwi-e.com, and change it. Then deploy a new version. That is the only change needed.

Can we see a log of all submissions?

Not by default with this setup — emails are the record. If a submission log is needed in the future, the script can be updated to also write each submission to a Google Sheet, giving a permanent searchable record of every form submission.